

Wednesday, August 31

This is the final day of our holiday. Cheryl and I have thought about it more than anything else. We have had a very good summer - to anyone else it might seem dull, but for us it has been the best yet.

Peter spent most of the day at Mama's. Matthew was awake at 6:30, which gave me an early start. After breakfast I wrote yesterday's journal and completed a problem on aging in the 21st Century. Matthew isn't up to his form and stayed close to Cheryl.

We went downtown at 11. Cheryl bought a snowsuit for Peter. I got a pair of shoes for school. Cheryl bought a blouse in Sears. Matthew was active.

I went to see Bill Krynowsky at PDR at 1:30, then Cheryl and Matthew joined me for dinner at The Bay. Matthew wouldn't sit down. He twisted out of the plastic strap and stood facing an old couple behind us. He talked. Peter was downtown too, but as we found out later he avoided us. The longer he stayed with Mama the likelier he would be riding the bus home again.

We went by Fabricland for elastic on the way to Mama's for Peter. I picked up several units of study at Roland Michener I had borrowed from Cheryl. We went to the DQ for ice-cream at 3:35. Perhaps that's an odd time to buy ice-cream, but Cheryl was fighting the fact that holidays are officially over.

We had a light supper after I mowed the lawn. I caught a couple of innings between the Expos and Giants. Peter and Matthew went into the tub, but Matthew was trying to walk from front to back so I bathed him quickly and got him out. Peter stayed until Cheryl took his place to get relief from the heat.

The evenings are much cooler than the days. A breeze came up, cool and fresh. Matthew and I walked down the block. He walks in circles, tongue curled out of his mouth. I could hear Peter as he plays with Erin and Devon. He's between the houses, a mountain lion screaming at his prey. Erin and Devon quit before he catches them.

We went to Rose Gyorgy's for coffee. Ann, the grandparents, Susan from California, Harvey, Margaret and Roy, Steven and Jan Ardell came at different times. Matthew stepped up and down on the step into the sunken living room. Peter taunted the adults sitting on the couch. His horrible green fingers inched out from under the couches and up their legs. He was so convincing that he frightened himself. He sat with the adults who were sitting on chairs.

We left at 10:20. Matthew fell asleep. We sat on the picnic table and watched the northern lights. Peter said they were Aurora Borealis. He got that from TV, he said.

He wanted to read *The Hobbit*, but it was too late. Tomorrow Crystal comes for the day. We go to school. Things will have to be snappy.